CSE0001-DIGITAL LITERACY

Project Report

Submitted By:

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PROGRAM: Integrated M.Tech

BRANCH: CSE AI

Project Role:

Student Digital Ambassador

Introduction

- As a Student Digital Ambassador, my goal was to create a Digital Literacy Portfolio to help peers.
- Over five modules, I focused on building professional profiles, communicating responsibly, and preventing cyber threats.
- I developed resources like educational infographics and cybercrime prevention checklists.
- All my work is organized in a central GitHub repository for easy access and sharing.
- This project provided hands-on experience in managing my online footprint effectively.
- It also allowed me to create materials that genuinely assist first-year students in their digital transition.

Task 1

For the first task of my Digital Literacy portfolio, I used Canva to design a comprehensive infographic titled "5 Pillars of Digital Literacy". As a Student Digital Ambassador, my objective was to create an accessible, one-page visual resource to help my batchmates understand essential digital skills. My design highlights five critical areas: defining the core meaning of digital literacy, identifying useful digital tools for modern coursework, maintaining safe internet practices to prevent cyber threats, building a foundational professional online presence for future career opportunities, and understanding proper email etiquette when contacting faculty.

One interesting aspect of creating this infographic was taking a pre-existing digital marketing template and completely repurposing its structure to fit an educational context. It required me to distill broad concepts into concise, impactful statements that fit the strict visual constraints of the design blocks. Conversely, I found it quite difficult to keep the descriptions brief while still conveying the necessary gravity of each topic, especially for complex subjects like digital safety. Ultimately, the visual format successfully breaks down these essential concepts into actionable, easy-to-digest pillars for first-year students.

Task 2

For my foundational digital portfolio, I chose to establish a professional presence on GitHub, Kaggle, and Stack Overflow. GitHub serves as the primary platform for version control and collaborative code hosting. Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub extensively to host my academic repositories, document my programming progress, and showcase technical projects, especially those relating to physics and circuit analysis. I selected Kaggle because it is an industry-standard platform for data science and machine learning. As I advance in my degree, I intend to utilize Kaggle to explore technical datasets, practice data analysis, and eventually participate in beginner-friendly competitions. Finally, I created a profile on Stack

Overflow, an invaluable community-driven Q&A platform for developers. My strategy for Stack Overflow is to initially use it as a learning resource to troubleshoot coding errors, with the long-term goal of actively contributing answers to help others. Establishing these three distinct profiles provides a strong foundation that supports both my immediate academic journey and long-term career aspirations.

Task 3

For this module, I explored both coding practice and cloud collaboration tools. First, I created an account on HackerRank to sharpen my programming logic. I completed the 'Solve Me First' Python challenge, which involved writing a basic function to compute the sum of two integers. Practicing Python is crucial for me since I want to use it for running physics simulations and calculating circuit parameters in the future. For the collaboration portion, I utilized Google Workspace to build a "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" via Google Forms. I designed five specific questions covering topics like the national cybercrime helpline and secure password management, and linked the form to a Google Sheet to automatically collect responses. This platform was incredibly intuitive. These tools will immensely help me academically; HackerRank will continuously test my technical logic, while Google Workspace will be my go-to for collaborating with classmates on group presentations and collecting data for research projects.

Task 4

In this task, I practiced professional online communication by drafting two emails: one requesting a deadline extension from a professor, and another inquiring about a summer internship. I also created a 10-point Do's and Don'ts checklist for social media. One scenario where poor digital communication caused a real problem happened when a student blindly forwarded an unverified, panic-inducing message about exam cancellations on a college WhatsApp group. It caused massive confusion and resulted in disciplinary action for the student. This situation could have easily been avoided by taking two minutes to verify the information with a faculty member first. My key learning here is that once you hit send—whether it is a formal email or a casual text in a group—it becomes part of your permanent digital footprint. Tone, clarity, and verification are everything.

Task 5

While researching UPI payment fraud for this cybercrime case study, what surprised me the most was how simple and common these tricks actually are. I always thought hacking involved complex computer coding, but most cybercrimes rely on basic human psychology, like creating a fake sense of urgency to make students panic. It is scary to realize that scammers can steal thousands of rupees just by tricking someone into scanning a simple QR

code on WhatsApp. As a result of this research, one major habit I will personally change is my rushing during digital payments. I will start taking a five-second pause to carefully read the payment screen and verify the receiver's name before I ever type in my UPI PIN, ensuring my personal finances stay completely safe.

Conclusion:-

Overall, this Digital Literacy project has completely reshaped how I view my online presence. I learned that being digitally literate is not just about knowing how to use software; it is about doing so responsibly, safely, and professionally. From setting up my foundational GitHub and Stack Overflow profiles to understanding the real-world dangers of UPI fraud, I now feel equipped to navigate the digital demands of college life. Acting as a Student Digital Ambassador taught me that protecting our digital footprint is an ongoing habit, one that will benefit me throughout my academic and professional career.

References:-

- Canva Design Platform (canva.com)
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- Kaggle (kaggle.com)
- Stack Overflow (stackoverflow.com)
- Hackerank (hackerrank.com)
- Google Forms (forms.google.com)
- National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal (cybercrime.gov.in)